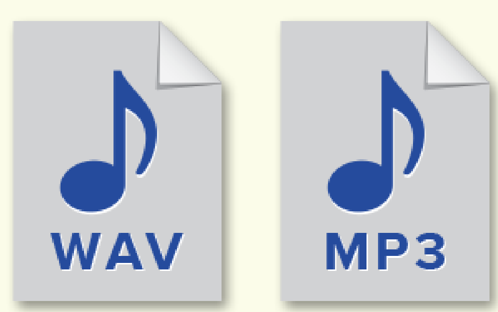
Audio Editor

11

Recall:

Audio refers to any sound, speech, or music. Audio created or converted with digital devices is called digital audio. Audio can be saved with different types of files. .wav and .mp3 are types of audio files.



11. Audio Editor

An audio editor is an application that records and edits sound. To record a sound is to save it in a digital format. To edit a sound is to perform actions like cut, copy, paste, and join. Audio editors have multiple purposes:

- To record audio
- To delete a part of an audio
- To add an extra part to the audio
- To join two or more different audios together

There are different audio editors like Audacity, Ocenaudio, Wavepad, Sound Forge, Adobe Audition, etc. In this lesson, we will explore the Audacity audio editor.

Audacity

Audacity is a popular audio editor. It is free to use. We can identify the Audacity editor with its logo.

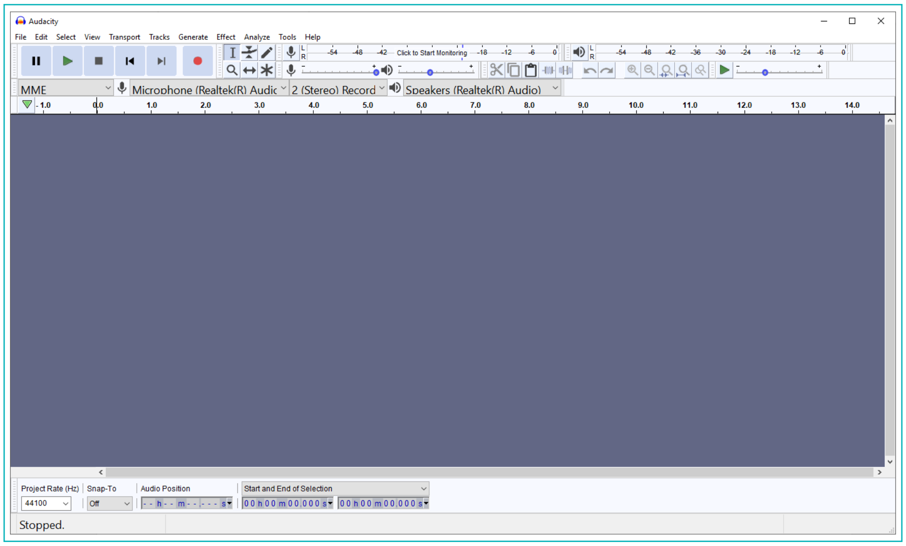
Audacity logo

Healthy Practices:

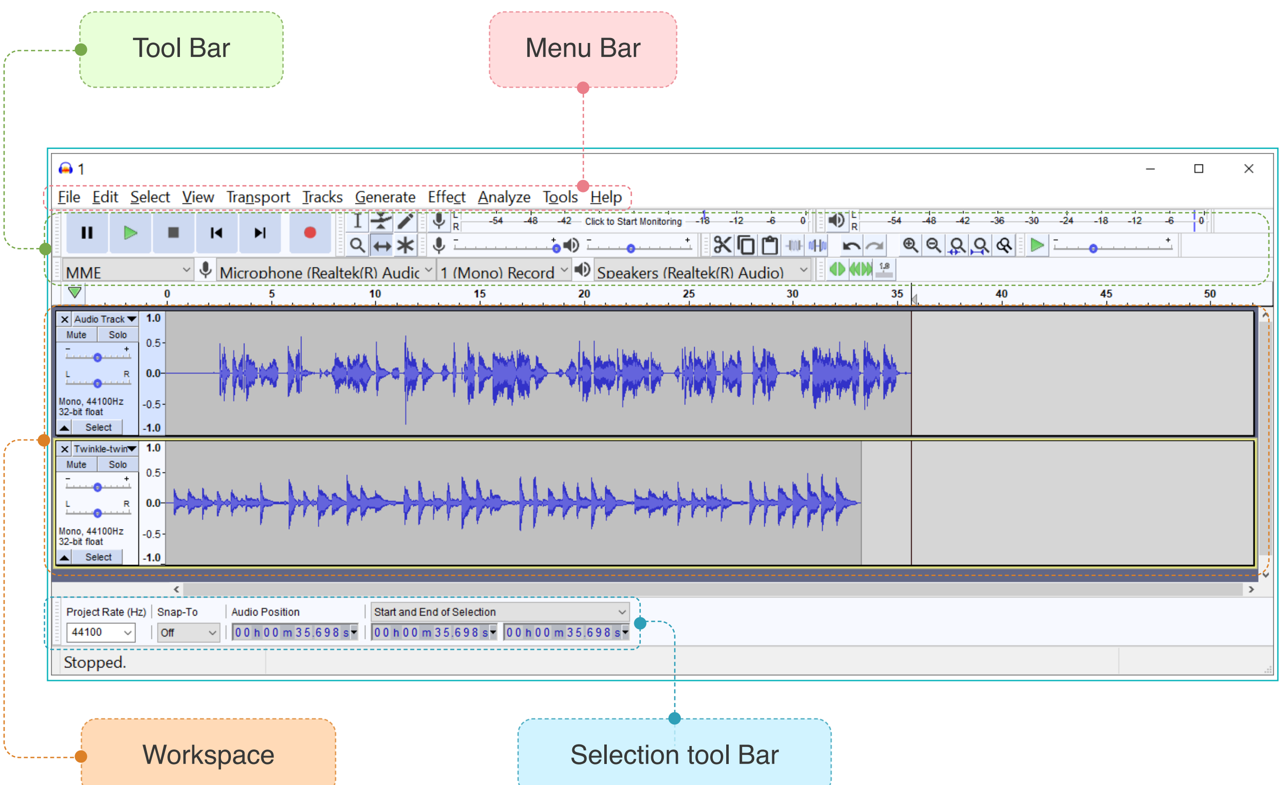
- Always download and install any software under adult supervision.

Audacity Interface

Audacity has lots of different functions and tools.



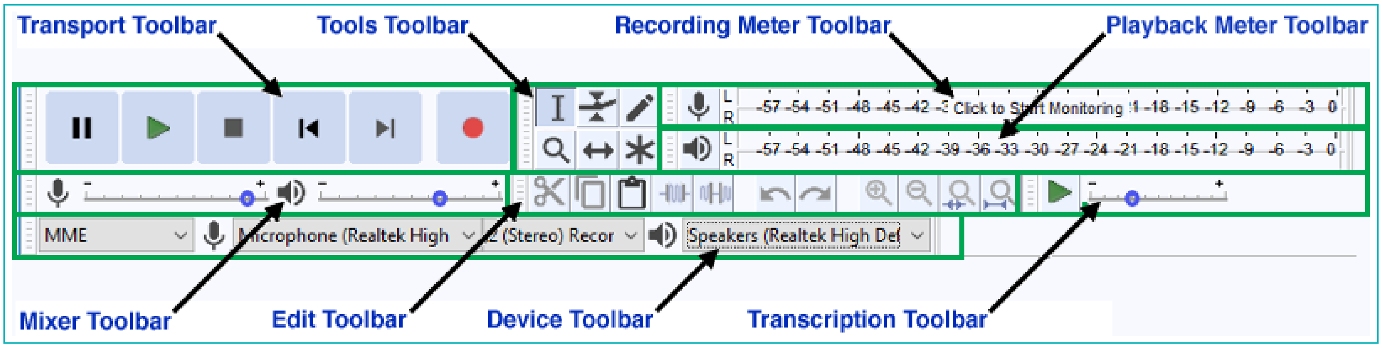
Once an audio file is added to it, it looks like this:



The wave like structure in the image above is an audio. We will look at the different tools in Audacity.

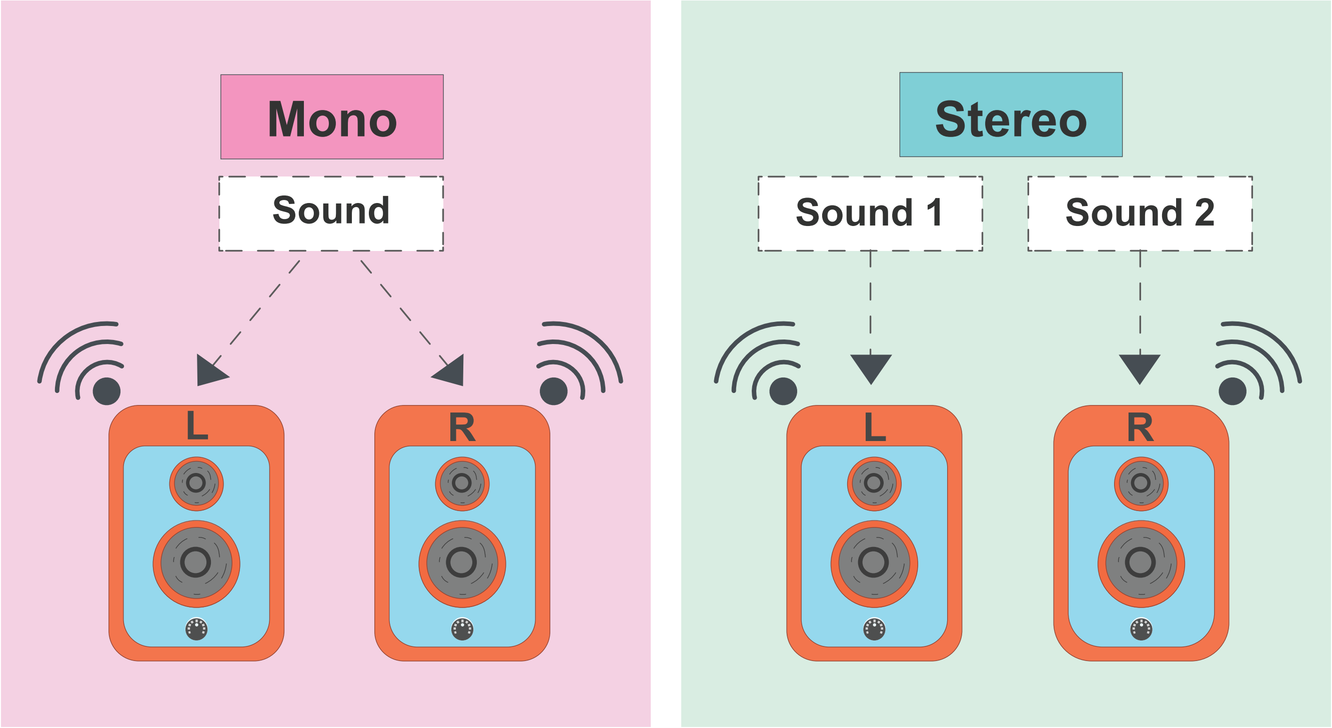
• Toolbar: The toolbar contains tools that help us perform different actions on an audio.

There are eight main Tool Bars in the Audacity software:

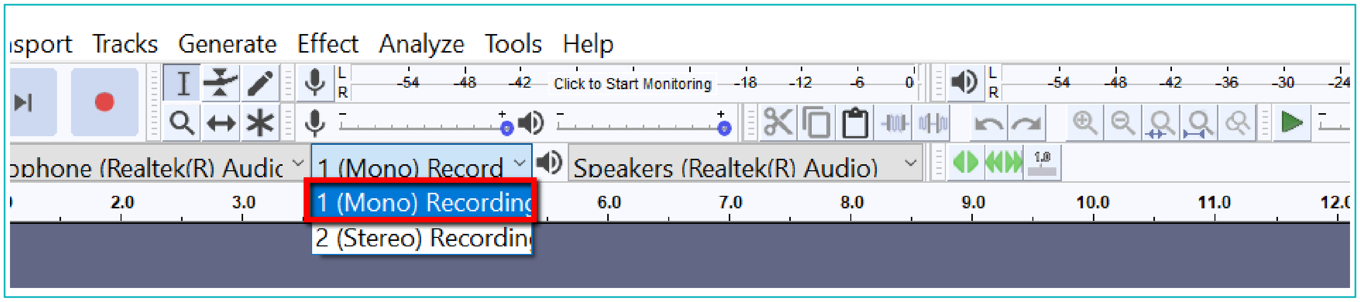


Initial Setup

Before we perform any operation on an audio, we need to setup the audio channel. The passage in which an audio passes is called a channel. When an audio uses one channel, it is called mono sound. Mono means one. When it uses two channels, it is called stereo sound.



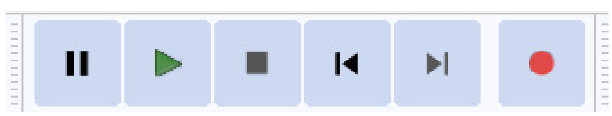
In the toolbar, set the channel type to Mono Recording

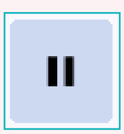
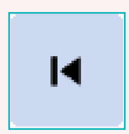
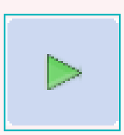
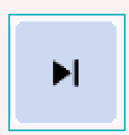
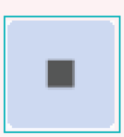
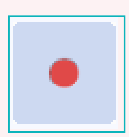


Record

Now, we will look at how to record an audio. Follow the steps given below and record an audio of your choice. Instead, you can also sing the poem "Twinkle twinkle little star". We can use headphones with microphone for recording.

The Transport toolbar has a few buttons that allow us to play, pause, stop, jump and record an audio.

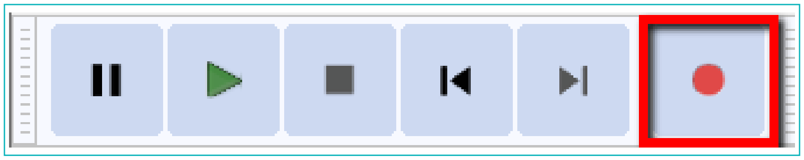


Button	Action	Button	Action
	Press the pause button to pause during playback or recording. Press again to resume.		Press to move the playback head to the start of the track.
	Press the play button to listen to the selected audio (or all audio) in the project.		Press to move the playback head to the end of the track.
	Press the stop button or hit the spacebar to stop playback.		Press the record button to record a new track from the computer's sound input device.

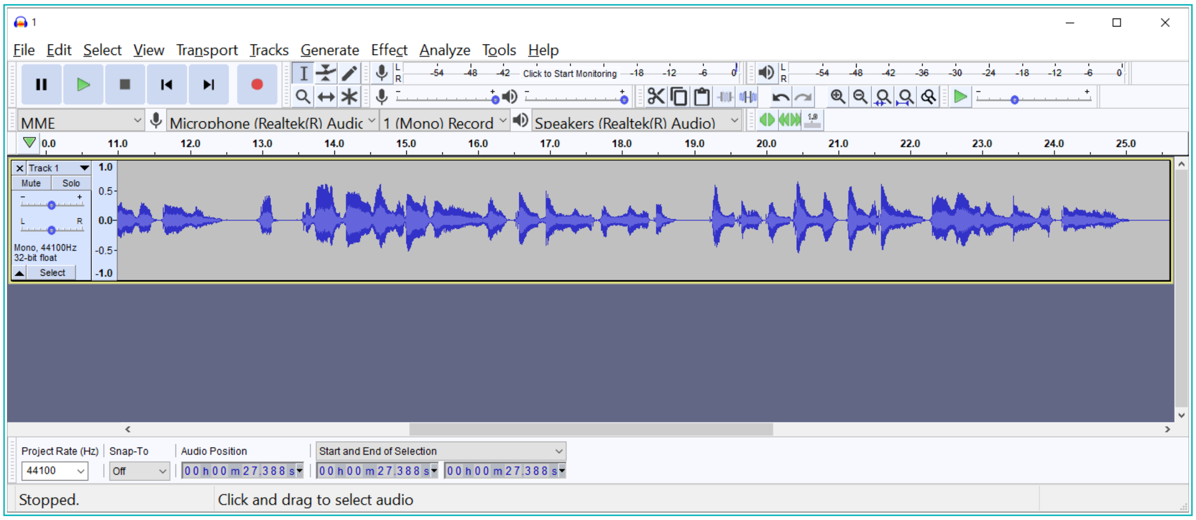
Bytes

To record sound, use a microphone

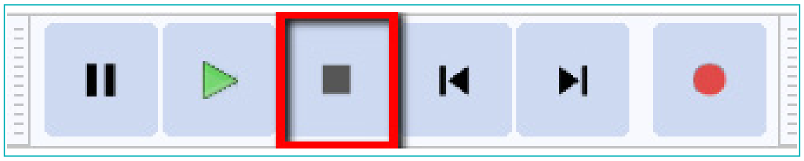
- To record, click on the record button and then start singing.



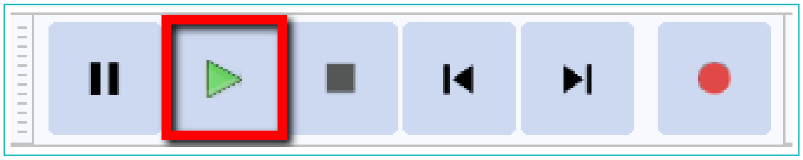
The Audacity screen will look like this:



- When you are done singing, click on the stop button to stop recording.

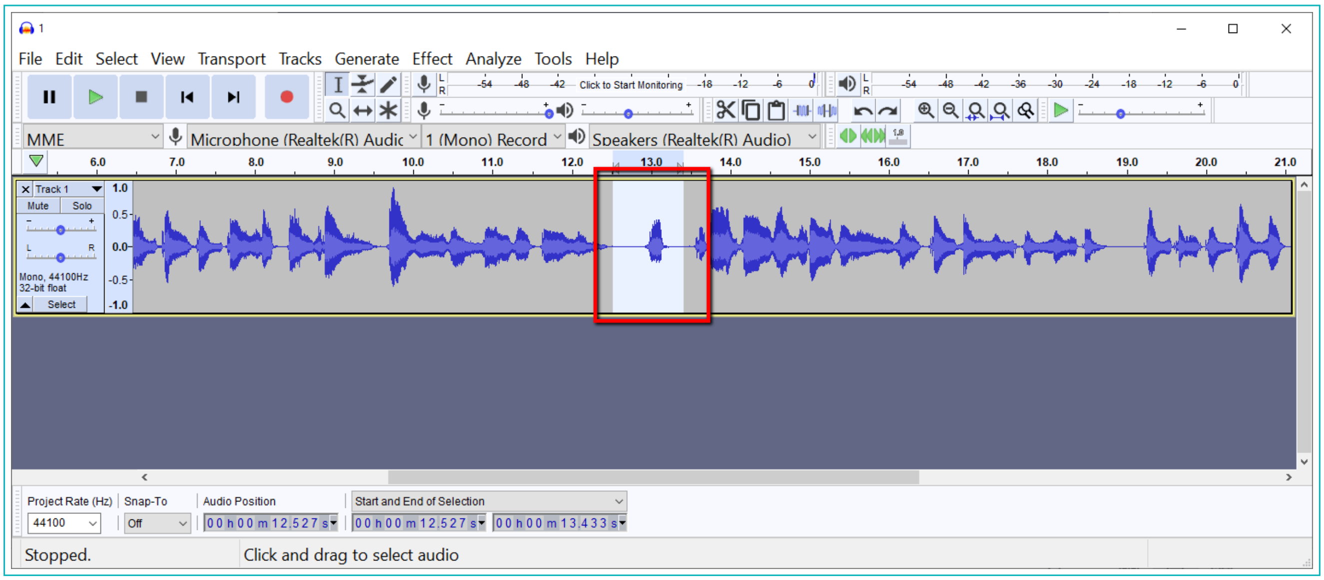


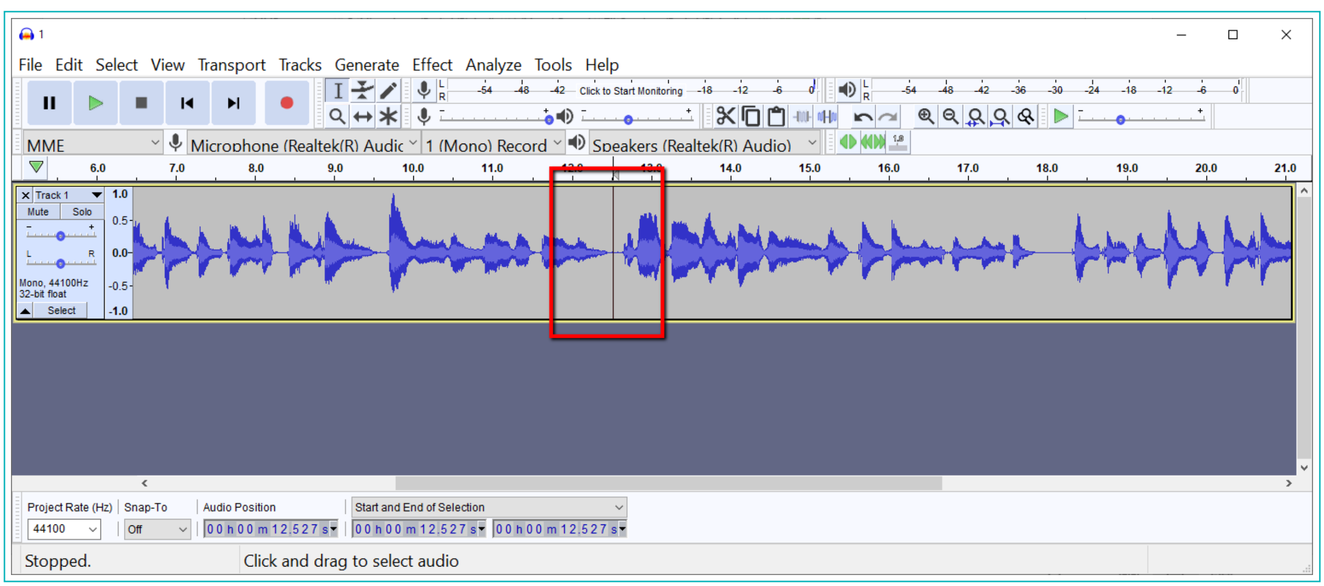
- Connect headphones or speakers to the computer to listen to the recorded audio.



Edit

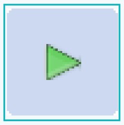
If there is a part of an audio that we don’t want to use, we can delete it. Use drag and drop to select it. Then click the Delete key on the keyboard.



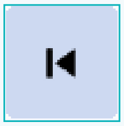


Exercise

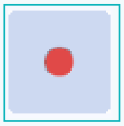
Match the pairs

1 a. 

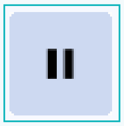
f. Press to move playback head to start of track.

b. 

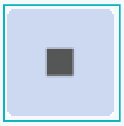
g. Press to stop playback immediately.

c. 

h. Press to pause during playback or recording. Press again to resume.

d. 

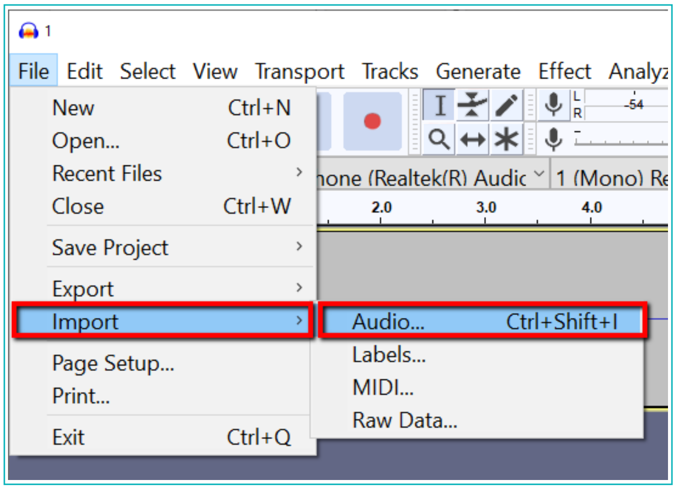
i. Press to listen to the selected audio (or all audio) in your project.

e. 

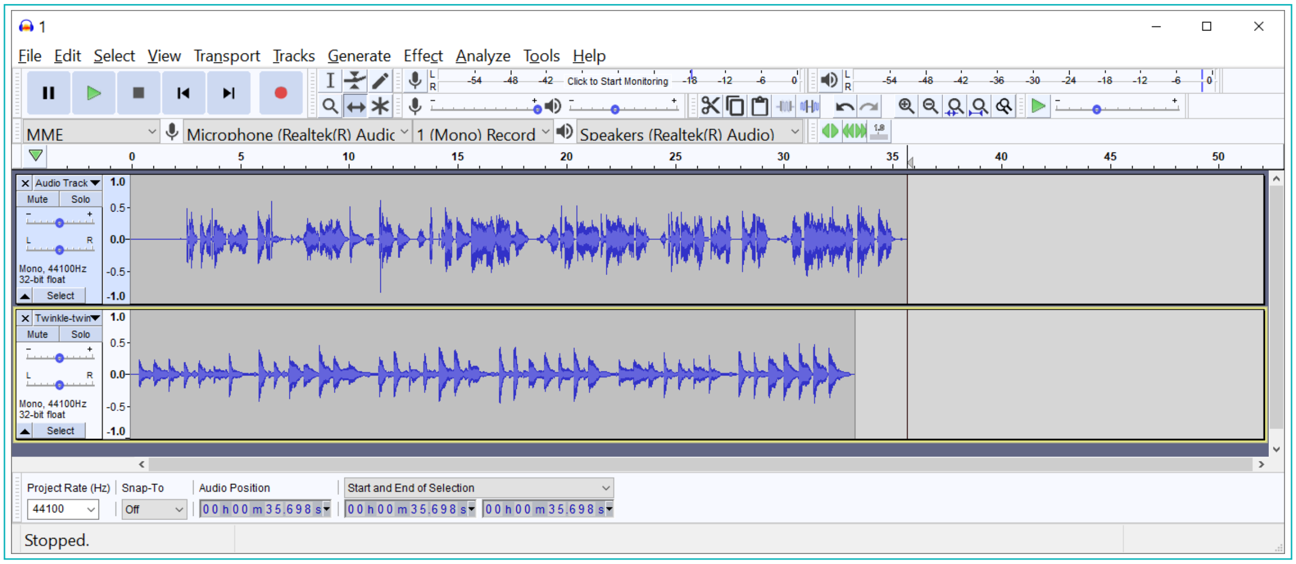
j. Press to record a new track from your computer's sound input device.

We have recorded an audio clip and edited it to remove an unwanted part. But the recorded sound does not have any background music like we hear in a song or movie. So, we will look at how to add background audio.

- Import the audio file to add in the background. The import option is used to add an audio clip to the existing file.
- Click on File, then click on Import and choose Audio.

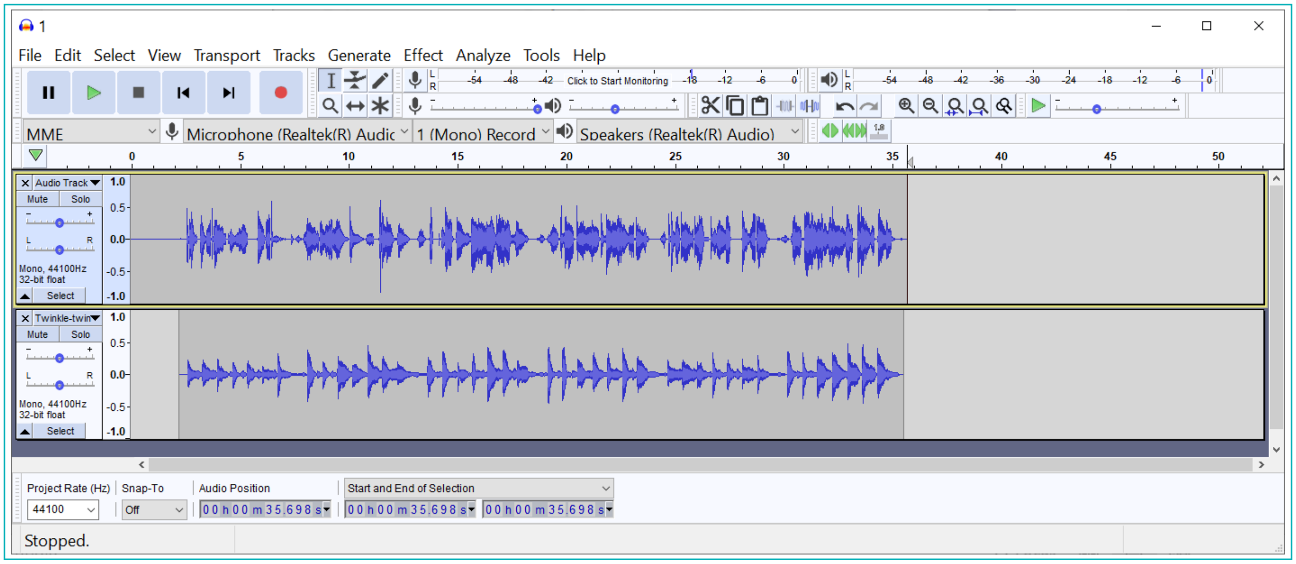


The screen will look like this:



To make it sound better, we need to align the background audio with our original audio.

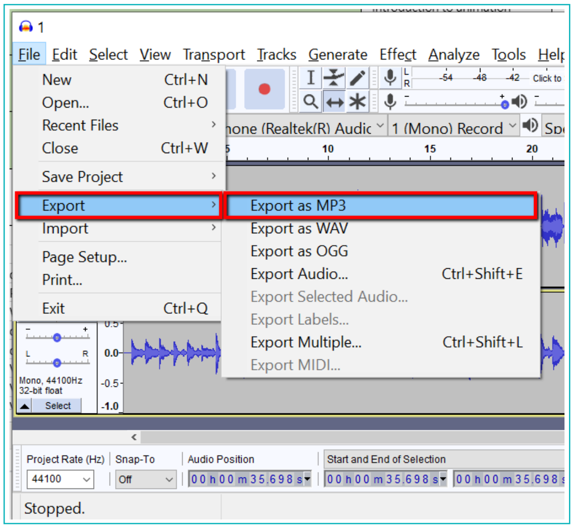
To do this, we use the  Timeshift tool in the toolbar.



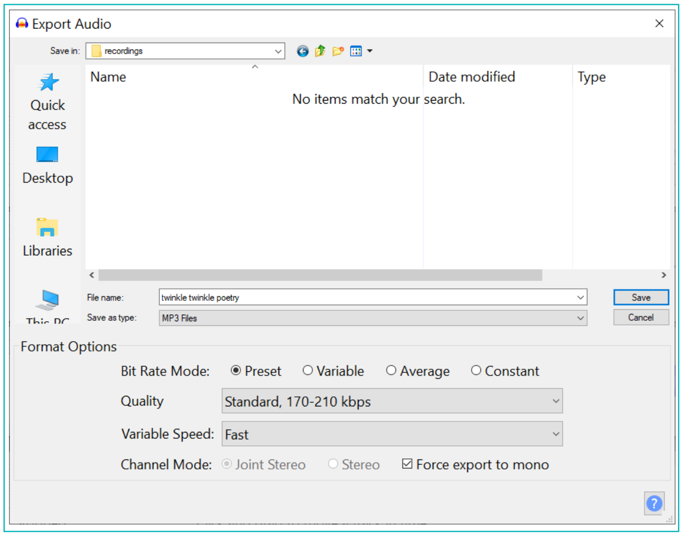
Export File

Now, our file is ready. We need to export the file to a media type that can be played on all multimedia devices. We will use mp3.

To export, follow the steps below:



1. Click on File, then select "Export", then choose "Export as MP3".



2. Select a folder to save the file in.
3. Name the file.
4. Click on save.

Play and enjoy the audio. Now you can record, edit, import and export any audio that you like.
In this lesson, we saw various functions of audio editor. Now, you can record and edit an audio of your choice.

Bytes

To export means to convert a file to a different type

Exercise

Fill in the blanks

2. ________________ option is used to add a track to an existing file
3. An ________________ is an application that can record and edit audio tracks.
4. Play, Pause, Stop buttons are a part of ________________ toolbar.

11. Audio Editor

Tech Flash

Audio Editor : An audio editor is an application that records and edits any type of sound.

Toolbar : The toolbar contains tools that help us to perform many operations.

Transport toolbar : It is used to play, pause, stop, seek, and record the audio in the application

Tools Toolbar : It enables your current tool for tasks such as selection, volume adjustment, horizontal zooming or audio time shifting.

TimeShift tool : It lets you synchronize audio in a project by dragging individual or multiple audio tracks.

.wav & .mp3 : These are two commonly used audio file formats

Future Tech

3D Audio Effects

3D audio effects are sound effects that manipulate the sound produced by different kinds of speakers. These could be stereo speakers, surround-sound speakers, speaker-arrays, or headphones. This usually involves virtually placing sound sources anywhere in a 3D space. The speakers can be placed behind, above, or below the listener.